# Northwind Labs Compensation Guidelines (HR Confidential)

## Salary Bands

This document is confidential and may only be shared within the HR team. Salary bands are reviewed every year in March.

Level L1 (Associate): INR 6 to 9 lakh per year. Level L2 (Engineer): INR 10 to 16 lakh per year. Level L3 (Senior Engineer): INR 18 to 28 lakh per year.

Level L4 (Lead): INR 30 to 45 lakh per year. Level L5 (Principal): INR 48 to 70 lakh per year.

## Annual Appraisal Cycle

The appraisal cycle runs every April. Managers rate each employee on a scale of 1 to 5, and ratings are calibrated across teams before they are final.

A rating of 5 earns an increment of 12 to 15 percent, a rating of 4 earns 8 to 11 percent, and a rating of 3 earns 4 to 7 percent. Ratings of 1 or 2 do not receive an increment and lead to a performance improvement plan.

## Bonus Policy

Employees at level L4 and above are eligible for an annual performance bonus of up to 15 percent of base salary. Employees at L1 to L3 are eligible for up to 8 percent.

Bonuses are paid with the June salary. Employees who resign before the payout date are not eligible for that year's bonus.